Powered Cube Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

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Dataset Snapshot

This run on Powered Cube uses 57,913 unique deck builds and 266,117 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 7 learned archetypes. Card win rates are games-in-hand (GIH) win rates; an archetype's win rate is over all of its games. The best-performing large shells are Boros Tokens | Guide of Souls / Sanguine Evangelist, Rakdos Midrange | Bloodtithe Harvester / Fire Covenant, Azorius Control | No More Lies / Teferi, Time Raveler, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and standalone bombs.

How to Read This Report

- **Coreness** measures how central a card is to an archetype: played in many of its decks, characteristic of it, and connected to the rest of the deck. Cards are grouped into Core, Support and Periphery rings. A core card may carry a tag: **signature** (in bold: played in at least 15% of this archetype's decks and in at most one other archetype at that rate) or *staple* (at least 25% of this archetype's decks and at least 15% in three or more archetypes); untagged core cards are neither.
- **Play rate** is the share of the archetype's decks that play at least one copy.
- **Bombs** are cards that are strong on their own. A bomb's **lift** compares, within the decks that play it, the win rate when the card is in hand with the win rate when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, and is shrunk across archetypes; it is shown in percentage points (pp). Bombs are listed whatever ring they sit in: core and support bombs keep their ring on the site, and only bombs that would otherwise be peripheral go to the bomb island beside the rings.
- A **synergy pair** wins more often when both cards are drawn than their separate effects predict (games-in-hand, adjusted for game length and play/draw). The effect λ is an interaction log-odds, shown as a percentage change in the odds of winning with its 95% confidence interval. Pairs are tested with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control: *verified* means $q \leq 0.10$, *tentative* means $q \leq 0.25$. Few pairs pass; an absent pair means "not detectable with this data", not "no synergy".
- **Payoff** and **engine** roles are decided by synergy arrows only: the synergy pairs (verified or tentative) whose direction is significant. In such a pair the arrow points from the payoff, the

card that wins more when drawn without its partner, to the engine it rewards; a card whose arrows mostly point out of it is a payoff, one whose arrows mostly point into it an engine. The arrow reflects each card's standalone strength within the pair, not a direction of the synergy itself. Played-together links carry the same arrow on the site as context only; they do not set roles.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Boros Tokens | Guide of Souls / Sanguine Evangelist	14,830	77,863	60.71%	Guide of Souls, Sanguine Evangelist, Luminarch Aspirant, Mother of Runes, Death-Greeter's Champion
Rakdos Midrange | Bloodtithe Harvester / Fire Covenant	5,378	25,254	54.65%	Bloodtithe Harvester, Fire Covenant, Kolaghan's Command, Kroxa, Titan of Death's Hunger, Barrowgoyf
Azorius Control | No More Lies / Teferi, Time Raveler	6,413	28,834	53.51%	No More Lies, Teferi, Time Raveler, Teferi, Hero of Dominaria, Fractured Identity, Wrath of God
Green Base Ramp | Birds of Paradise / Ignoble Hierarch	10,417	44,846	51.88%	Birds of Paradise, Ignoble Hierarch, Noble Hierarch, Malevolent Rumble, Titania, Protector of Argoth
Dimir Reanimator | Psychic Frog / Animate Dead	7,926	34,538	51.43%	Psychic Frog, Animate Dead, Necromancy, Reanimate, Entomb
Blue Base Artifacts | Mox Opal / Urza, Lord High Artificer	6,918	29,388	50.68%	Mox Opal, Urza, Lord High Artificer, Kappa Cannoneer, Retrofitter Foundry, Tezzeret, Cruel Captain
Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	6,031	25,394	49.91%	Underworld Breach, Brain Freeze, Lion's Eye Diamond, Expressive Iteration, Dack Fayden

2 Core of Each Archetype

The core ring of each archetype, most central first, with the share of the archetype's decks that play each card and its tag where it has one: **signature** (in bold) or staple. The second line lists the archetype's bombs, whatever ring they sit in: cards that are strong on their own, with their lift (in-hand vs in-library win rate within the decks that play them, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes) and their games in hand.

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Boros Tokens 14,830 decks	**Sanguine Evangelist** (33%, signature), **Luminarch Aspirant** (33%, signature), **Guide of Souls** (35%, signature), **Mother of Runes** (32%, signature), **Death-Greeter's Champion** (32%, signature), **Showdown of the Skalds** (29%, signature) *Bombs:* Black Lotus (+9.7 pp, 2,287 games); Mox Pearl (+8.5 pp, 3,020 games); Ancestral Recall (+7.2 pp, 1,010 games); Mana Crypt (+6.6 pp, 2,411 games)
Green Base Ramp 10,417 decks	**Titania, Protector of Argoth** (27%, signature), **Nadu, Winged Wisdom** (25%, signature), **Noble Hierarch** (26%, signature), **Birds of Paradise** (28%, signature), **Scythecat Cub** (25%, signature), **Icetill Explorer** (25%, signature) *Bombs:* Time Walk (+10.9 pp, 1,876 games); Black Lotus (+10.2 pp, 1,576 games); Ancestral Recall (+8.6 pp, 1,529 games); Sol Ring (+6.3 pp, 1,465 games)
Dimir Reanimator 7,926 decks	**Animate Dead** (29%, signature), **Necromancy** (26%, signature), **Entomb** (25%, signature), **Archon of Cruelty** (25%, signature), **Psychic Frog** (31%, signature), **Life // Death** (23%, signature), **Reanimate** (28%, signature), **Griselbrand** (22%, signature), **Collective Brutality** (21%, signature) *Bombs:* Time Walk (+9.2 pp, 1,470 games); Ancestral Recall (+7.8 pp, 1,787 games); Tinker (+6.5 pp, 602 games); Black Lotus (+6.5 pp, 1,201 games)
Blue Base Artifacts 6,918 decks	**Kappa Cannoneer** (36%, signature), **Mox Opal** (38%, signature), **Pinnacle Emissary** (29%, signature), **The Mightstone and Weakstone** (31%, signature), **Saheeli, Sublime Artificer** (29%, signature), **Urza, Lord High Artificer** (37%, signature), **Retrofitter Foundry** (36%, signature), **Upheaval** (26%, signature), **Tezzeret, Cruel Captain** (32%, signature), **Nettlecyst** (31%, signature) *Bombs:* Ancestral Recall (+8.4 pp, 1,179 games); Tinker (+7.8 pp, 4,150 games); Time Walk (+7.7 pp, 1,004 games); Sol Ring (+7.5 pp, 1,645 games)
Azorius Control 6,413 decks	**Teferi, Hero of Dominaria** (34%, signature), **Teferi, Time Raveler** (38%, signature), **No More Lies** (37%, signature), **Fractured Identity** (33%, signature) *Bombs:* Time Walk (+9.5 pp, 1,904 games); Ancestral Recall (+8.4 pp, 2,014 games); Tinker (+6.9 pp, 585 games); Black Lotus (+6.6 pp, 922 games)
Izzet Storm 6,031 decks	**Brain Freeze** (31%, signature), **Underworld Breach** (31%, signature), **Lion's Eye Diamond** (27%, signature), **Expressive Iteration** (26%, signature) *Bombs:* Ancestral Recall (+8.6 pp, 1,698 games); Time Walk (+8.1 pp, 1,934 games); Black Lotus (+6.9 pp, 1,400 games); Sol Ring (+6.7 pp, 938 games)
Rakdos Midrange 5,378 decks	**Kolaghan's Command** (30%, signature), **Bloodtithe Harvester** (32%, signature), **Fire Covenant** (36%, signature), **Caustic Bronco** (23%, signature), **Kroxa, Titan of Death's Hunger** (25%, signature) *Bombs:* Black Lotus (+9.0 pp, 906 games); Ancestral Recall (+8.5 pp, 551 games); Time Walk (+7.3 pp, 384 games); Sol Ring (+6.4 pp, 826 games)

3 What Defines the Best Shells

Boros Tokens | Guide of Souls / Sanguine Evangelist

This cluster contains 14,830 decks across 77,863 games and posts a baseline win rate of 60.71%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Sanguine Evangelist` (33% of decks), `Luminarch Aspirant` (33% of decks), `Guide of Souls` (35% of decks), `Mother of Runes` (32% of decks), `Death-Greeter's Champion` (32% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Guide of Souls`, `Sanguine Evangelist`, `Luminarch Aspirant`, `Mother of Runes`, `Death-Greeter's Champion`, `Ajani, Nacatl Pariah`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Black Lotus` (+9.7 pp), `Mox Pearl` (+8.5 pp), `Ancestral Recall` (+7.2 pp). None of the 496 card pairs tested passed the false-discovery-controlled synergy test, so any specific two-card synergy in this shell is unproven; its strength comes from its core and card quality.

Rakdos Midrange | Bloodtithe Harvester / Fire Covenant

This cluster contains 5,378 decks across 25,254 games and posts a baseline win rate of 54.65%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Kolaghan's Command` (30% of decks), `Bloodtithe Harvester` (32% of decks), `Fire Covenant` (36% of decks), `Caustic Bronco` (23% of decks), `Kroxa, Titan of Death's Hunger` (25% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Bloodtithe Harvester`, `Fire Covenant`, `Kolaghan's Command`, `Kroxa, Titan of Death's Hunger`, `Barrowgoyf`, `Caustic Bronco`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Black Lotus` (+9.0 pp), `Ancestral Recall` (+8.5 pp), `Time Walk` (+7.3 pp). None of the 496 card pairs tested passed the false-discovery-controlled synergy test, so any specific two-card synergy in this shell is unproven; its strength comes from its core and card quality.

Azorius Control | No More Lies / Teferi, Time Raveler

This cluster contains 6,413 decks across 28,834 games and posts a baseline win rate of 53.51%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Teferi, Hero of Dominaria` (34% of decks), `Teferi, Time Raveler` (38% of decks), `No More Lies` (37% of decks), `Fractured Identity` (33% of decks). Its defining signposts are `No More Lies`, `Teferi, Time Raveler`, `Teferi, Hero of Dominaria`, `Fractured Identity`, `Wrath of God`, `Sunfall`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Time Walk` (+9.5 pp), `Ancestral Recall` (+8.4 pp), `Tinker` (+6.9 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 0 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 1 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest tentative pair is `Mana Drain` + `Teferi, Hero of Dominaria`: +59% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+23, +106]%, 377 games).

Green Base Ramp | Birds of Paradise / Ignoble Hierarch

This cluster contains 10,417 decks across 44,846 games and posts a baseline win rate of 51.88%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Titania, Protector of Argoth` (27% of decks), `Nadu, Winged Wisdom` (25% of decks), `Noble Hierarch` (26% of decks), `Birds of Paradise` (28% of

decks), Scythecat Cub (25% of decks). Its defining signposts are Birds of Paradise, Ignoble Hierarch, Noble Hierarch, Malevolent Rumble, Titania, Protector of Argoth, Nadu, Winged Wisdom.

Bombs that win on their own here: Time Walk (+10.9 pp), Black Lotus (+10.2 pp), Ancestral Recall (+8.6 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 0 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 1 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest tentative pair is Nadu, Winged Wisdom + Noble Hierarch: +46% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+17, +81]%, 472 games).

4 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Cards flagged as bombs in at least one archetype, whatever ring they sit in on the site, each shown in the archetype where its lift is largest. *Lift*: within the decks that play the card, the win rate when it is in hand vs when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes. *Raw lift*: the card's games-in-hand win rate minus the archetype baseline, not shrunk.

Card	Archetype	Lift	Raw lift	GIH WR	Games
Time Walk	Green Base Ramp	+10.9 pp	+12.3 pp	64.18%	1,876
Black Lotus	Green Base Ramp	+10.2 pp	+11.9 pp	63.83%	1,576
Ancestral Recall	Green Base Ramp	+8.6 pp	+9.7 pp	61.54%	1,529
Mox Pearl	Boros Tokens	+8.5 pp	+7.8 pp	68.54%	3,020
Tinker	Blue Base Artifacts	+7.8 pp	+9.1 pp	59.81%	4,150
Sol Ring	Blue Base Artifacts	+7.5 pp	+12.7 pp	63.40%	1,645
Mana Crypt	Boros Tokens	+6.6 pp	+6.7 pp	67.40%	2,411
Brain Freeze	Izzet Storm	+6.6 pp	+5.9 pp	55.79%	3,931
Flash	Dimir Reanimator	+6.3 pp	+7.6 pp	58.99%	3,024
Pyrogoyf	Rakdos Midrange	+6.2 pp	+8.7 pp	63.39%	1,983
Ajani, Nacatl Pariah	Boros Tokens	+6.1 pp	+5.5 pp	66.21%	8,636
Mox Ruby	Boros Tokens	+5.8 pp	+6.2 pp	66.86%	2,873
Minsc & Boo, Timeless Heroes	Green Base Ramp	+5.7 pp	+7.2 pp	59.08%	4,421
Mox Sapphire	Blue Base Artifacts	+5.7 pp	+11.0 pp	61.73%	1,411

5 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Life // Death	Dimir Reanimator | Psychic Frog / Animate Dead	10.0 / 10	17.23 pp	2818
Lion's Eye Diamond	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	10.0 / 10	23.70 pp	2829
Frantic Search	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	10.0 / 10	23.85 pp	1871

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Echo of Eons	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	8.4 / 10	12.68 pp	2158

6 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Brain Freeze	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.686	5.88 pp	3931
Underworld Breach	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.624	5.74 pp	3639
Spell Pierce	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.588	1.62 pp	2162
Animate Dead	Dimir Reanimator | Psychic Frog / Animate Dead	0.578	6.54 pp	4000
Expressive Iteration	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.567	2.97 pp	2954
Entomb	Dimir Reanimator | Psychic Frog / Animate Dead	0.509	5.39 pp	3555
Frantic Search	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.450	-2.40 pp	1983
Life // Death	Dimir Reanimator | Psychic Frog / Animate Dead	0.444	1.12 pp	2978
Lion's Eye Diamond	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.442	0.72 pp	2975
Hullbreacher	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.430	7.30 pp	2484
Echo of Eons	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	0.430	0.29 pp	2299

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Collective Brutality	Dimir Reanimator | Psychic Frog / Animate Dead	0.419	2.09 pp	3049

7 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Ugin, Eye of the Storms	Blue Base Artifacts | Mox Opal / Urza, Lord High Artificer	10.0 / 10	2.93 pp	mythic
Psychic Frog	Dimir Reanimator | Psychic Frog / Animate Dead	10.0 / 10	2.59 pp	rare
Tinker	Blue Base Artifacts | Mox Opal / Urza, Lord High Artificer	10.0 / 10	1.32 pp	uncommon
Ajani, Nacatl Pariah	Boros Tokens | Guide of Souls / Sanguine Evangelist	10.0 / 10	2.03 pp	mythic
Retrofitter Foundry	Blue Base Artifacts | Mox Opal / Urza, Lord High Artificer	9.9 / 10	2.15 pp	rare
Parallax Wave	Boros Tokens | Guide of Souls / Sanguine Evangelist	10.0 / 10	1.84 pp	rare
Barrowgoyf	Rakdos Midrange | Bloodtithe Harvester / Fire Covenant	10.0 / 10	3.04 pp	rare
Minsc & Boo, Timeless Heroes	Green Base Ramp | Birds of Paradise / Ignoble Hierarch	10.0 / 10	2.26 pp	mythic
Urza, Lord High Artificer	Blue Base Artifacts | Mox Opal / Urza, Lord High Artificer	9.0 / 10	1.31 pp	mythic
Pyrogoyf	Izzet Storm | Underworld Breach / Brain Freeze	10.0 / 10	6.39 pp	rare
Malevolent Rumble	Green Base Ramp | Birds of Paradise / Ignoble Hierarch	10.0 / 10	2.02 pp	common

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Mox Opal	Blue Base Artifacts | Mox Opal / Urza, Lord High Artificer	8.8 / 10	1.58 pp	mythic

8 Verified Synergy Pairs

Every pair below passed a pair-interaction test on games-in-hand data, stratified by game length and play/draw, with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control across all pairs tested in its archetype. λ is the interaction log-odds, shown as the change in the odds of winning when both cards are drawn, with its 95% confidence interval. Across all archetypes, 12 pairs are verified ($q \leq 0.10$) and 26 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$, marked †).

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Brain Freeze + Underworld Breach	Izzet Storm	+175%	[+133, +224]%	<0.001	69.90%	1,392
Brain Freeze + Lion's Eye Diamond	Izzet Storm	+73%	[+45, +107]%	<0.001	62.61%	1,011
Animate Dead + Entomb	Dimir Reanimator	+78%	[+45, +119]%	<0.001	71.38%	622
Entomb + Necromancy	Dimir Reanimator	+55%	[+26, +90]%	0.008	66.20%	574
Expressive Iteration + Frantic Search	Izzet Storm	+76%	[+30, +139]%	0.027	62.04%	216
Lion's Eye Diamond + Underworld Breach	Izzet Storm	+39%	[+16, +66]%	0.027	59.79%	955
Echo of Eons + Hullbreacher	Izzet Storm	+54%	[+21, +95]%	0.031	63.89%	432
Frantic Search + Underworld Breach	Izzet Storm	+48%	[+19, +84]%	0.032	58.57%	519
Frantic Search + Spell Pierce	Izzet Storm	+80%	[+28, +153]%	0.040	60.36%	169
Brain Freeze + Frantic Search	Izzet Storm	+43%	[+16, +77]%	0.043	58.17%	569
Collective Brutality + Necromancy	Dimir Reanimator	+49%	[+19, +86]%	0.063	63.48%	460
Collective Brutality + Life // Death	Dimir Reanimator	+56%	[+21, +101]%	0.065	62.58%	326
Narset, Parter of Veils + Tendrils of Agony	Izzet Storm	+86%	[+24, +180]%	0.112†	61.21%	116
Frantic Search + Remand	Izzet Storm	+62%	[+16, +127]%	0.140†	63.59%	184
Frantic Search + Narset, Parter of Veils	Izzet Storm	+52%	[+14, +103]%	0.140†	59.27%	248
Animate Dead + Collective Brutality	Dimir Reanimator	+43%	[+14, +79]%	0.140†	65.61%	442
Entomb + Life // Death	Dimir Reanimator	+41%	[+13, +74]%	0.140†	63.58%	508
Mana Drain + Teferi, Hero of Dominaria	Azorius Control	+59%	[+23, +106]%	0.146†	71.88%	377
Lion's Eye Diamond + Narset, Parter of Veils	Izzet Storm	+44%	[+11, +87]%	0.161†	61.44%	319

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Galvanic Discharge + Remand	Izzet Storm	+72%	[+16, +153]%	0.163†	71.07%	159
Brain Freeze + Remand	Izzet Storm	+42%	[+10, +84]%	0.163†	67.53%	348
Black Lotus + Underworld Breach	Izzet Storm	+52%	[+12, +106]%	0.165†	72.36%	275
Black Lotus + Echo of Eons	Izzet Storm	+65%	[+14, +138]%	0.166†	68.12%	160
Narset, Parter of Veils + Underworld Breach	Izzet Storm	+44%	[+10, +88]%	0.166†	66.01%	303

9 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pairs whose interaction is significantly negative ($q \leq 0.10$): they win less often when drawn together than their separate effects predict.

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	Pair WR	Games
Ponder + Time Walk	Izzet Storm	-44%	[-61, -20]%	51.88%	160
Icetill Explorer + Minsc & Boo, Timeless Heroes	Green Base Ramp	-42%	[-56, -24]%	48.58%	247
Descendant of Storms + Figure of Destiny	Boros Tokens	-32%	[-44, -18]%	51.75%	543

10 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. Each archetype is described first by its core: the cards that are played in most of its decks, characteristic of it and connected to the rest of the deck. Bombs are listed separately because they win on their own and are worth taking (and often splashing) whatever the shell. Synergy claims are deliberately conservative: only pairs that survive a false-discovery-controlled interaction test are reported, with their effect size and confidence interval, so the short pair list is a feature of honest statistics rather than a lack of interplay between the cards.